

point-and-shoot cameras and digital SLRs, there are the pseudo SLRs or the super zoom or bridge cameras as they are better known as these days. These are cameras with a huge optical zoom lens and share many of the features of a DSLR camera. The ease of use is similar to any other point and shoot though.

Once you've decided on what kind of camera you want, there's a few things to look for. The sensor size although not talked about a lot is important – it's an important component that's responsible for the detail and quality of the photo and is not to be neglected. The zoom lens is also important if you plan on using it to shoot long range photographs of wildlife

Nikon D90



or any kind of action sports. Obviously, you also should pay attention to other factors such as the build quality, the ease of use and what kind of memory it uses. If you're buying a DSLR, there's also the availability of accessories such as the lens and flash units available for that camera.

Back to the shop, I found some people looking at the very attractive PowerShot SX series from Canon. The SX120 IS and the SX200 IS models were the ones. The SX120 IS was a little affordable at around Rs. 13,000. The SX200 IS is the slightly more expensive model. I had a quick look at the camera and remember handling it in the test centre. It's a well-built camera for sure. If you can spend the few thousands more, go for this. Samsung, although not best known for its cameras, has a few models which come with exceptionally good lenses. Samsung's ES55 is one of the models that we highly recommend if you have a smaller budget.

Now, Canon isn't the only one making these super zoom cameras. One of the most power zoom lens cameras comes from Sony. Their DSC-HX1 model had a powerful 20x zoom lens – that's more than enough to shoot objects some 500 m away, assuming you have clear conditions. One of the things I realised while I was at this shop was that people were actually enquiring about DSLRs. They all had an understand that they were superior cameras